

A Formal Illumination of the Five Laws of Existence

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Abstract

This paper treats the five laws of existence as candidate natural axioms and asks what structure becomes visible if they are read as mutually coherent principles. In this reconstruction, existence cannot be negated; every experience is accessed here and now; the one and the many imply one another through a relation of participation rather than simple set identity; the state a perspective gives to reality constrains what it receives; and every manifest content changes while the invariant law-structure remains. Formalization serves this purpose by removing ambiguity so that the laws can be examined as a unified metaphysical grammar rather than as separate ideas. The resulting model presents a typed phenomenological ontology in which consciousness, perspective, belief, and manifestation arise within All That Is, while All That Is is held within The One. This hierarchy functions as a clarifying constraint on the model, not as a replacement for the paper's central aim of illuminating the five laws as a unified structure.

Keywords. five laws of existence, natural axioms, The One, All That Is, consciousness, metaphysics, ontology, monism, philosophy of time, process philosophy, participatory ontology, formalization, illumination.

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1 Introduction

The five laws considered here can be stated without ornament.

1. You exist.
2. Everything is here and now.
3. The One is the All and the All are the One.
4. What you put out is what you get back.
5. Everything changes except the first four laws.

They are approached here as candidate natural axioms, not as property, doctrine, or personal achievement, but as truths the model treats as implicit in existence. The task is to make their structure apparent.

The guiding question is therefore direct. *What structure becomes visible when the five laws are treated as mutually coherent axioms of existence?* The work below uses formalization as a clarifying instrument rather than as an additional doctrine. It translates each law into explicit terms so that its natural place in the system can be seen without unnecessary literalism. For example, “what you put out is what you get back” is not modeled as a crude guarantee that any single wish causes a matching event. It is modeled as a feedback thesis in which beliefs, meanings, affective stance, and action constrain the field of experiences that can be recognized, selected, interpreted, and enacted by an agent.

Relevant literature is used in the same spirit. Bashar and Darryl Anka are cited for disseminating the five laws in the form of teachings [2, 1]. Official session resources are cited only to orient the hierarchy language around The One, All That Is, and consciousness, not to turn that hierarchy into the paper’s main thesis [5, 3, 4]. Such literature does not replace the laws with academic categories, but sharpens their apparent structure. The comparisons are structural analogies only; they do not imply that the cited authors endorse the five-law metaphysics. The five laws are not identical to Quine’s criterion of ontological commitment, McTaggart’s argument about time, Schaffer’s priority monism, Bandura’s reciprocal determinism, Merton’s self-fulfilling prophecy, Varela–Thompson–Rosch enactivism, Whiteheadian process thought, or Buddhist accounts of dependent origination and impermanence. These bodies of work do, however, provide useful comparison points for clarifying what the laws make apparent and what they do not assert [14, 11, 15, 6, 12, 16, 17, 8, 9].

2 Method and Scope

The treatment is intentionally impersonal because the aim is disclosure rather than attribution. It begins from the five statements themselves and asks what must already be true of existence for them to cohere. The method is illumination through clarification, removing conceptual noise until the laws can stand forward as natural axioms.

A stable cluster of explanatory ideas appears across the five laws.

1. A Law, in this sense, is unbreakable rather than merely local to one reality.
2. Existence is primitive, so whatever exists may change form or expression but cannot become nonexistence.
3. Space, time, past, and future appear as perspectival arrangements within a single present field rather than as ultimately separate containers.
4. The One is not reduced to All That Is; All That Is contains consciousness, manifestation, and individuated perspectives through which unity becomes experienceable.
5. Reality functions like a mirror, with belief, emotion, behavior, and state of being organizing the kind of reality one experiences.
6. Change applies to all forms, perspectives, beliefs, and experiences, while the structural laws remain invariant.

The illumination below is therefore intentionally *structural*. It makes the five-law pattern explicit, consistent, and comparable while preserving its character as an impersonal disclosure of existence rather than a constructed doctrine.

3 Pre-Formal Concepts

The laws require a few distinctions before they can be formalized.

Definition 1 (Typed domains and participation). *Let One denote The One, the encompassing ground that contains but is not exhausted by All That Is. Let All denote All That Is, the self-reflective totality in which existence, consciousness, manifestation, and perspective become knowable. Let $\mathcal{E}$ be the typed domain of existents articulated within All, and let $\text{Ex}(e)$ mean that $e \in \mathcal{E}$. Let $\mathcal{C}$ denote consciousness as reflective participation within All, let P denote the conscious perspectives considered by the model, and let $\mathcal{D}$ denote the typed domain of changeable contents such as manifestations, states, beliefs, memories, bodies, events, and local forms.*

The relation $X \preceq Y$ means that X participates in, is contained in, or is grounded by Y at the relevant level of analysis. It is not ordinary set inclusion, and it is assumed to be transitive.

$$\Omega \preceq \text{All} \preceq \text{One}, \quad \mathcal{C} \preceq \text{All}, \quad \forall p \in P (p \in \mathcal{E} \wedge p \preceq \mathcal{C}).$$

The notation is intentionally non-exhaustive. It fixes only the containment and participation relations needed by the paper: consciousness is not outside All That Is, and All That Is is not identical with the full scope of The One. In this technical usage, “All That Is” names the reflective totality of modeled existence rather than an exhaustive denial that The One exceeds it.

Definition 2 (Manifestation, mode, and content). *For an existent $e \in \mathcal{E}$, let $\mathcal{M}(e)$ be the collection of modes through which e may be expressed. A manifestation is an appearance, form, event, body, belief, memory, object, relation, or perspective through which an existent is expressed. A content $c \in \mathcal{D}$ is changeable material within experience. A content may present a mode of an existent, but it is not thereby the invariant existent itself.*

Definition 3 (Perspective). *A perspective $p \in P$ is an individuated conscious point of view within $\mathcal{E}$ and therefore within All That Is. A perspective does not stand outside existence or consciousness; it is one way All That Is locally interprets and experiences within The One.*

Definition 4 (Here-now access and indexing). *Let $\mathbf{N}$ denote the present access-field as it is available within All That Is. For perspective p , $\text{Access}_p(e)$ is the present access-relation through which $e \in \mathcal{E}$ is encountered. Apparent location and time are represented by an index map*

$$\lambda_p : \mathcal{E} \rightarrow H_p \times T_p,$$

where H_p is the apparent spatial horizon and T_p is the apparent temporal horizon for perspective p .

Definition 5 (Output). *For an agent or perspective a , define*

$$\text{Out}_a = \langle B_a, M_a, A_a, C_a \rangle,$$

where B_a is the agent's operative belief-structure, M_a its meaning-assignments, A_a its affective stance or embodied readiness, and C_a its conduct or enacted choices. The tuple is not reducible to verbal affirmation; it is the total pattern the agent contributes to experience.

These definitions make it possible to distinguish four levels of claim. The first level names The One as encompassing ground. The second names All That Is as the self-reflective totality that includes consciousness, perspectives, and manifest existence. The third contains perspectival access and indexing, including time, place, identity, and circumstance as they are experienced. The fourth contains local contents, including the changeable forms, stories, bodies, and environments that appear inside experience.

4 The Five Laws as Axioms

4.1 Law One — You Exist

Axiom 1 (Existence invariance). *For every existent $e \in \mathcal{E}$,*

$$\text{Ex}(e) \rightarrow \Box \text{Ex}(e).$$

Equivalently, if e exists, then the fact of e 's existence is invariant under change of mode.

Here $\Box$ does not mean ordinary logical necessity in every possible philosophical system. It means necessity relative to this metaphysical frame. Existence, once admitted, has no transition into absolute nonexistence. The relevant transformation is therefore not

$$\text{Ex}(e) \longrightarrow \neg \text{Ex}(e),$$

but

$$(\text{Ex}(e) \wedge m_1 \in \mathcal{M}(e)) \longrightarrow (\text{Ex}(e) \wedge m_2 \in \mathcal{M}(e)).$$

This captures the first law’s distinction between changing form and invariant existence. It does not imply that every transient content $c \in \mathcal{D}$ is itself invariant; contents are treated under Law Five. The philosophical analogue is the ancient problem of being and non-being, later reframed in analytic metaphysics as the problem of what a theory must count as existing [14, 13]. The law is not Quine’s criterion, but both treat ontology as the basic question of what there is.

Proposition 1 (No absolute annihilation). *Within this system, death, loss, forgetting, and transformation can be represented only as changes of mode, perspective, content, or access-relation, not as the conversion of an existent into absolute nonexistence.*

Proof. By Axiom 1, if $\text{Ex}(e)$ for $e \in \mathcal{E}$, then $\Box \text{Ex}(e)$. A transition to $\neg \text{Ex}(e)$ is therefore disallowed in the model. Since the fifth law nevertheless affirms change, the permitted transformations must apply to modes, contents, expressions, or relations rather than to existence as such. $\square$

4.2 Law Two — Everything Is Here and Now

Axiom 2 (Indexical present access). *For every perspective $p \in P$ and existent $e \in \mathcal{E}$, the existent is encountered through the present access-field,*

$$\text{Access}_p(e) \in \mathbf{N}, \quad \lambda_p : \mathcal{E} \rightarrow H_p \times T_p.$$

The apparent spacetime ordering of e for p is generated by $\lambda_p(e)$, not by placing e itself inside $\mathbf{N}$ as a member.

This is not simple presentism in the usual philosophy-of-time sense, because the law does not merely privilege the present instant within a line of time. It is closer to a perspectival or indexical thesis: “past,” “future,” “there,” and “elsewhere” are coordinates assigned by a viewpoint to what is accessed here-now.

The formal role of λ_p is to explain why ordinary experience appears linear even if the model treats all frames as co-present in access. For a perspective p , $\lambda_p(e) = (h, t)$ means that e appears at spatial coordinate h and temporal coordinate t for that perspective. The coordinate is not denied; its ultimacy is denied. This lets the model preserve ordinary planning and memory at the level of manifestation while assigning ontological primacy to present access. McTaggart’s famous challenge to the reality of time is a useful structural comparison, because it also separates temporal appearance from ultimate metaphysical status, though by a very different argument [11]. This comparison is analogical only; it does not imply endorsement of the five-law metaphysics.

Corollary 1 (Past and future as access-relations). *In this system, memory and anticipation are not contacts with nonexistent regions. They are present access-relations to contents indexed by λ_p within All That Is.*

4.3 Law Three — The One Is the All and the All Are the One

Axiom 3 (Nested reciprocal monism). *There exists an encompassing One One and a self-reflective All That Is All such that All That Is participates in The One, consciousness participates in All That Is, and every modeled existent is articulated within All That Is.*

$$\Omega \preceq \text{All} \preceq \text{One}, \quad \text{C} \preceq \text{All},$$

and

$$\forall e \in \mathcal{E} (\text{Ex}(e) \rightarrow e \preceq \text{All}).$$

All That Is includes the field of existents, conscious perspectives, and the relations through which The One becomes reflectively knowable. For every perspective p , $\text{View}_p(\text{One})$ is a local disclosure within All That Is.

This axiom combines priority monism with perspectival plurality while preserving the hierarchy introduced above. The One is not merely the sum of all contents, and All That Is is not placed outside or beside The One. The One is the encompassing ground; All That Is is the reflective totality in which consciousness, manifestation, and perspectives occur. The law’s reciprocal wording is therefore read as reciprocal disclosure rather than as identity between relata of the same type: The One is disclosed through All That Is, and All That Is is grounded in The One. Plurality is not dismissed as illusion in a merely negative sense. It is how All That Is renders unity experienceable.

The closest academic analogue is not a perfect match, but Schaffer’s priority monism is helpful because it asks whether the cosmos, rather than its smallest parts, is metaphysically fundamental [15]. Bohm’s language of wholeness and implicate order supplies another structural comparison point for a whole enfolded in local appearances [7]. Buddhist dependent origination, especially in Madhyamaka interpretation, is also relevant because it resists independent self-subsistence and treats phenomena as mutually conditioned [8, 9]. These comparisons are analogical only. The present formulation differs by preserving affirmative language for The One while distinguishing that ground from the experiential totality of All That Is.

Proposition 2 (Difference without separation). *If Axiom 3 holds, then difference is real at the level of perspective within All That Is but not absolute at the level of The One.*

Proof. For any two perspectives p and q , $p \neq q$ can hold as a distinction of viewpoint. By Axiom 3, each perspective participates in All That Is, and All That Is participates in The One. Since $\preceq$ is transitive, each perspective participates in The One. Therefore no perspective is outside All That Is, and no manifestation is outside The One. Separateness is perspectival, not ultimate. $\square$

4.4 Law Four — What You Put Out Is What You Get Back

Axiom 4 (Reflective feedback). *For every perspective a and perspective-relative ordering index k , experienced reality at the next modeled step belongs to the possible-experience field constrained by output and co-present conditions:*

$$\text{Exp}_{a,k+1} \in \text{PossibleExp}(\text{Out}_{a,k}, E_k),$$

where E_k is the wider field of co-present conditions within All That Is and $\text{Out}_{a,k} = \langle B_a, M_a, A_a, C_a \rangle_k$ is the agent's operative output. The index k is not an absolute temporal instant; it is an ordering parameter internal to the model's iterative presentation of experience and compatible with the perspective-relative indexing of Law Two.

This is the most easily misunderstood law. If read as a simplistic claim that every event is consciously chosen, it becomes ethically and empirically crude. A stronger formalization treats the law as constraint and feedback between state and world. Beliefs filter salience; meanings determine whether a circumstance is experienced as threat, opportunity, punishment, or invitation; affect changes perception and action-readiness; action changes the social and material environment. In the nested model, this feedback occurs within All That Is, where conscious perspectives and manifest conditions meet. The “mirror” does not make a victim blameworthy for what occurs. It means that experience is inseparable from the interpretive and enacted pattern through which a perspective meets the field.

This reading is compatible with several neighboring literatures. Merton's self-fulfilling prophecy shows how a definition of a situation can evoke behavior that helps make the definition come true [12]. Bandura's social cognitive theory models person, behavior, and environment as reciprocally determining one another [6]. Enactive cognitive science argues that cognition is not passive representation of a pregiven world, but world-involving embodied action [16]. These comparisons do not prove the metaphysics, but they show that feedback between stance, interpretation, conduct, and experienced world is a serious cross-disciplinary theme.

Proposition 3 (Responsibility without total blame). *Axiom 4 entails participatory responsibility for one's experiential relation to circumstances, but it does not entail that every circumstance is individually, consciously, or morally deserved.*

Proof. The possible-experience field includes E_k , the wider field of co-present conditions within All That Is, in addition to $\text{Out}_{a,k}$. Therefore output constrains experience but is not the only variable in the system. Blame would require reducing $\text{PossibleExp}(\text{Out}_{a,k}, E_k)$ to a singleton determined entirely by the voluntary portion of $\text{Out}_{a,k}$, which the axiom does not state. $\square$

4.5 Law Five — Everything Changes Except the First Four Laws

Axiom 5 (Dynamic closure). *Let*

$$\mathcal{K} = \{L_1, L_2, L_3, L_4\}$$

be the invariant object-level kernel of the system. Law Five is represented as the meta-level closure rule

$$L_5^* : \quad \forall c \in \mathcal{D} \Diamond \text{Changes}(c),$$

and the expanded invariant structure is

$$\mathcal{K}^+ = \mathcal{K} \cup \{L_5^*\}.$$

The rule L_5^ is not itself a changeable content $c \in \mathcal{D}$.*

Law Five is best understood as a meta-law that states the relation between invariant structure and changing content. This avoids a self-reference problem. If the fifth law were merely one more object-level content, the phrase “except the first four laws” might seem to make the fifth law changeable in a way that destabilizes the system. As a closure rule, however, Law Five says that the first four laws are the invariant object-level kernel and that contents generated within the system are dynamic. If the fifth law appears as a sentence, memory, or inscription inside experience, that appearance is a content and may change; the meta-level closure rule is not such a content. The claim concerns contents and relations within All That Is, not The One treated as one more changing object.

Whitehead’s process philosophy is the most natural academic comparison because it treats becoming as metaphysically basic rather than as a secondary feature added to static substances [17]. Heraclitean and Buddhist traditions also treat impermanence as a central feature of the manifest world [10, 9]. These are structural comparisons only. The present formulation differs by pairing radical change with an explicit invariant kernel and meta-level closure rule.

5 Integrated Model

The five laws can be gathered into a single model.

$$\mathcal{B} = \langle \text{One}, \text{All}, \Omega, \mathcal{E}, \mathcal{M}, \mathcal{D}, \mathbf{N}, P, \lambda, \text{Access}, \text{PossibleExp}, \preceq, \mathcal{K}^+ \rangle,$$

where **One** is the encompassing ground, **All** is All That Is, Ω is the modeled existence-field within **All**, $\mathcal{E}$ is the typed domain of existents, $\mathcal{M}$ assigns modes to existents, $\mathcal{D}$ is the domain of changeable contents, $\mathbf{N}$ is the present access-field, P is the set of conscious perspectives, λ is the family of spacetime-indexing maps, **Access** is the family of present access-relations, **PossibleExp** is the constraint field for possible experiences, $\preceq$ is the participation or grounding relation, and $\mathcal{K}^+$ is the invariant law-structure including the meta-level closure rule.

Law	Formal role	Interpretive consequence
You exist	$\forall e \in \mathcal{E} (\text{Ex}(e) \rightarrow \Box \text{Ex}(e))$	Existents are invariant; modes, access, and contents may change.
Here and now	$\text{Access}_p(e) \in \mathbf{N}, \lambda_p : \mathcal{E} \rightarrow H_p \times T_p$	Space and time are perspectival coordinates assigned through present access.
One and all	$\Omega \preceq \text{All} \preceq \text{One}, \mathbf{C} \preceq \text{All}$	The One grounds All That Is; consciousness and perspectives belong within All That Is.
Output returns	$\text{Exp}_{a,k+1} \in \text{PossibleExp}(\text{Out}_{a,k}, E_k)$	Experience is participatory, reflective, and constrained without total blame.
Change	$L_5^* : \forall c \in \mathcal{D} \Diamond \text{Changes}(c)$	Contents are mutable; the invariant kernel and meta-rule are not contents.

The integrated model has a simple architecture. Law One supplies ontological persistence for typed existents. Law Two supplies the field in which access and indexing occur. Law Three supplies the nested participation relation among The One, All That Is, consciousness, and local perspectives.

Law Four supplies experiential feedback within All That Is without asserting deterministic equality. Law Five supplies dynamism while preserving structural invariance. In short, existence persists, appears locally, differentiates perspectively, constrains experience through output and field, and changes in content.

This nesting prevents two category errors without becoming a separate doctrine inside the paper. The One is not reduced to an inventory of manifest things, and consciousness is not placed outside All That Is as a detached observer. Consciousness is instead one reflective mode through which All That Is participates in disclosure.

6 Comparative Discussion

6.1 Ontological Minimalism and Ontological Maximalism

Quine’s “On What There Is” is methodologically austere because a theory’s ontological commitments are read through what it must quantify over [14]. Law One is metaphysically maximal rather than austere because it does not merely ask what a theory quantifies over, but asserts that existence itself is the irreversible predicate of any existent. The comparison is useful because it shows that the first law is not an empirical observation but a rule for what can count as a metaphysical transition.

6.2 The Present Field and the Philosophy of Time

Law Two can sound like ordinary mindfulness, but in the five-law system it is stronger. It claims not merely that one should attend to the present, but that temporal and spatial differences are accessed from a present field and indexed by a perspective. McTaggart’s argument that time is unreal is not the same thesis, yet it gives a rigorous precedent for distinguishing temporal appearance from ultimate metaphysical structure [11]. This comparison is structural only. The law is less an argument against time than a model of time as a perspective-indexing function.

6.3 Monism Without Erasing Plurality

Law Three should not be flattened into “only the One exists and individuals are unreal,” nor into a simple equation between The One and the collection of all contents. The correction is structural rather than thematic: the paper still studies the five laws as a whole, while Law Three distinguishes The One as encompassing ground from All That Is as the reflective field containing consciousness, manifestation, and perspectives. Unique perspective is essential because All That Is reflects unity through differentiated viewpoints. Schaffer’s priority monism helps clarify how a whole may be fundamental without making the parts experientially irrelevant [15]. Dependent-origination literature also helps because it denies isolated self-subsistence while preserving conventional phenomena [8, 9].

6.4 Reflection, Belief, and Ethical Caution

Law Four is powerful but dangerous if overstated. A rigorous version must reject two extremes. It should reject naive externalism, where experience simply happens to passive subjects. It should also reject naive blame, where every hardship is treated as privately chosen or deserved. The feedback formalization preserves agency while keeping the wider field E_k inside a possible-experience constraint rather than a deterministic equality. This resonates structurally with reciprocal causation in social cognitive theory and with enactivism's view that cognition and world-involvement are inseparable [6, 16].

6.5 Change and Invariance

Law Five gives the system its process character. Everything that can appear as content can change, including identity stories, bodies, moods, social arrangements, beliefs, meanings, and worlds of experience. Yet change is intelligible only against something that functions as structure. The model therefore differs from pure flux metaphysics because it is a process ontology with a fixed object-level kernel and an explicit meta-level closure rule. Whitehead is useful here as a structural comparison because his metaphysics also treats actuality as process rather than inert substance [17].

7 Implications

Several implications follow if the formal model is accepted internally.

First, selfhood is not identical with a fixed biography. Since existence persists and modes change, a person is not reducible to any one body-state, role, memory cluster, or narrative. Identity becomes a continuity of existential participation rather than a static object.

Second, the present is not merely a point on a timeline. It is the access-structure through which any timeline is encountered. Practical life can still include planning, regret, memory, and anticipation, but these are present operations rather than escapes from the present.

Third, unity does not eliminate individuality. In the model, individuality is how All That Is becomes articulate within The One. Ethical relation follows from this: another being is not merely external matter but another perspective within All That Is.

Fourth, belief is not merely private opinion. In the feedback model, belief is part of an enacted output pattern that organizes attention, interpretation, affect, behavior, and therefore experience. Changing belief is not magic in the trivial sense; it is a change to the operating parameters through which a world is met.

Fifth, impermanence becomes liberating rather than threatening. If every non-kernel content can change, then no present limitation is metaphysically final. The same law that dissolves fixed security also dissolves fixed despair.

8 Limitations

The reconstruction has four limits. First, it is internal and formal, not evidential. It clarifies what becomes apparent when the five laws are treated as a system; it does not demonstrate them as empirical facts. Second, the inquiry is deliberately impersonal, so it does not attempt to establish historical priority or ownership. Third, academic comparison does not imply academic endorsement. Quine, McTaggart, Schaffer, Merton, Bandura, Varela, Whitehead, and Buddhist philosophers are cited because their work helps locate the laws among recognizable philosophical and cognitive-scientific questions, not because they prove or endorse the five-law metaphysics. Fourth, the Bashar-related sources are used for orientation and terminology rather than as exhaustive transcript evidence. The refined hierarchy functions only as a clarifying constraint: it prevents a category mistake between The One, All That Is, and consciousness while leaving the paper's main motivation unchanged.

9 Conclusion

The five laws become apparent as a concise metaphysical grammar. Law One reveals existence as invariant for typed existents rather than for every transient content. Law Two reveals apparent spacetime as indexed through present access. Law Three reveals a nested unity in which The One grounds All That Is, while All That Is includes consciousness and the perspectives through which unity becomes reflectively manifest. Law Four reveals experience as a constrained feedback relation between output and field. Law Five reveals manifestation as dynamic while preserving the first four laws and the closure rule as invariant structure. Taken together, the laws form a process-oriented, participatory, perspectival ontology in which existence is locally indexed as many viewpoints, dynamically reflecting the patterns through which it is engaged.

The value of formalization lies in serving the paper's single motivation, which is to make the laws apparent without making them possessive. It shows where the claims are metaphysical rather than empirical, where they parallel established philosophical problems, where they require ethical caution, and where their internal logic is strongest. The hierarchy of The One, All That Is, and consciousness functions as a quiet constraint on the model rather than as a competing theme. The five laws can be studied as a compact disclosure of questions that recur wherever existence is examined. What cannot be lost? Where is experience located? How are the one and many related? How does consciousness participate in the world it experiences? What changes, and what does not?

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